Social Media Privacy and Account Hardening Audit

Project 03 | Beginner Level

Audit field	Details
Student	Muhammad Ali Kashif
Accounts audited	Google, Facebook, Instagram and LinkedIn
Audit completed	20 October 2026
Evidence reviewed	27 screenshots, including before-and-after settings
Overall result	Nine hardening changes completed; remaining exposure assessed as Low

Executive summary

I reviewed the privacy and security configuration of four accounts that I actively use. The review covered profile visibility, post audiences, friend or connection visibility, two-factor authentication, active sessions, connected applications and public search exposure. Nine practical hardening changes were completed and verified with screenshots. The most important improvements were enabling two-factor authentication, limiting discoverability, reducing public profile information, restricting reuse and tagging, ending old sessions and removing unnecessary application access.

The initial risk level was Medium because several settings increased account discovery, content reuse or unauthorized-access risk. After remediation, the residual risk is Low. Normal public exposure remains through professional and social profile search results, so quarterly reviews and prompt removal of unfamiliar sessions are recommended.

Scope and method

The audit was limited to accounts owned by the student. No password, one-time code, authenticator secret, recovery code or private message was collected. Sensitive phone, email, IP-address and location data has been concealed in the evidence reproduced in this report.

Account inventory and audit coverage

Account	Opened	Approximate age	Privacy areas reviewed	Security areas reviewed
Facebook	30 Dec 2010	Almost 16 years	Profile fields, posts, friends list, apps	2FA, sessions, connected apps
Instagram	2017	About 9 years	Tags, mentions, sharing and reuse	Meta 2FA and login sessions
Google	2020	About 6 years	Account information and recovery visibility	2-Step Verification, prompts, devices
LinkedIn	2020	About 6 years	Connections and phone discoverability	2FA, sessions, permitted services

Privacy and security findings

Account	Initial finding	Risk	Completed response	Final status
Google	2-Step Verification was disabled.	High	2-Step Verification enabled; recovery methods and prompts reviewed.	Secured
Facebook	Some profile fields were public; several connected apps remained listed.	Medium	Profile visibility tightened and unnecessary app access reduced.	Hardened
Instagram	Broad tagging, mentioning and content-sharing permissions.	Medium	Tagging and sharing/reuse controls restricted.	Hardened
LinkedIn	2FA disabled, seven sessions, connection list visible and phone discoverability open to everyone.	High	2FA enabled, old sessions ended, connections hidden, discoverability limited.	Secured

Risk rating method

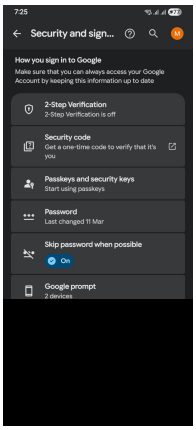
High means the weakness could directly support account takeover or significant exposure. Medium means it could increase unwanted discovery, impersonation, profiling or content misuse. Low means limited impact or a control already operating effectively. Ratings reflect likelihood and impact before remediation; the residual rating reflects the final configuration shown in the evidence.

Initial risk	High: 2	Medium: 3	Low: 1
Residual risk	High: 0	Medium: 0	Low: 6

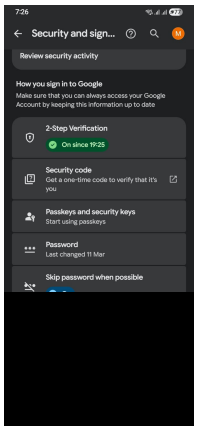
Hardening evidence 1 to 3

The paired screenshots below record the original state and the verified configuration after each change. Sensitive recovery information has been concealed.

1 Google 2-Step Verification

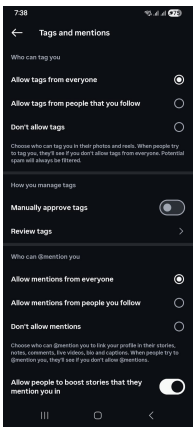


Before: *2-Step Verification displayed as off (High risk).*

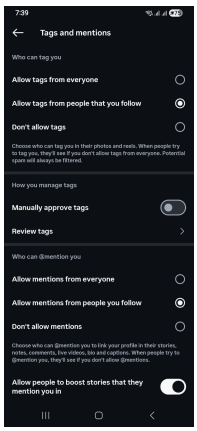


After: *2-Step Verification displayed as on.*

2 Instagram tag controls

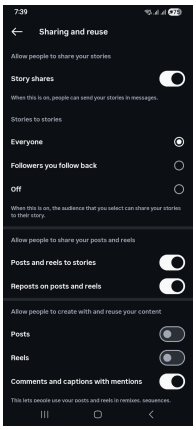


Before: *Tags were allowed broadly.*

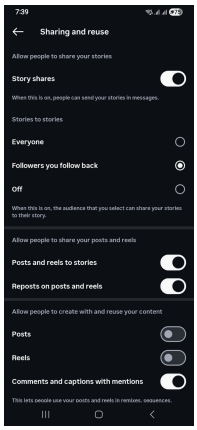


After: *Tag permissions were restricted.*

3 Instagram sharing and reuse



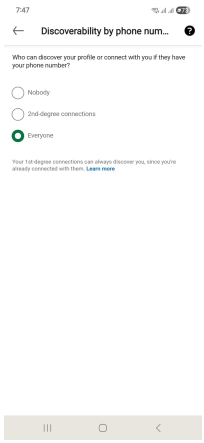
Before: *Story and content reuse permissions were broad.*



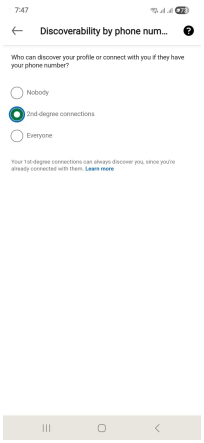
After: *Sharing and reuse permissions were reduced.*

Hardening evidence 4 to 6

4 LinkedIn phone discoverability

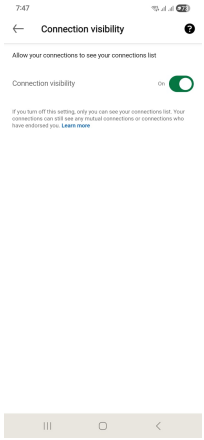


Before: *Anyone with the phone number could discover the profile.*

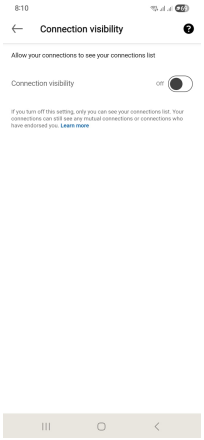


After: *Discoverability was limited to 2nd-degree connections.*

5 LinkedIn connection visibility

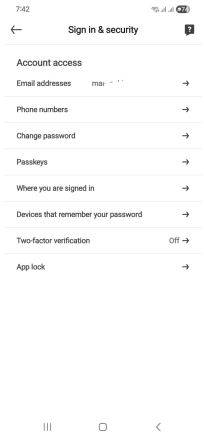


Before: *Connections list visibility was on.*

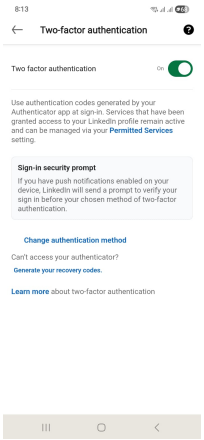


After: *Connections list visibility was turned off.*

6 LinkedIn two-factor authentication



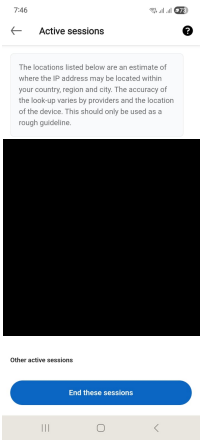
Before: *Two-factor verification was off (High risk).*



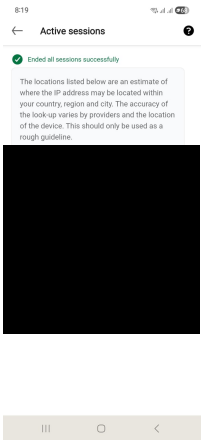
After: *Authenticator-based two-factor authentication is on.*

Hardening evidence 7 to 9

7 LinkedIn active sessions

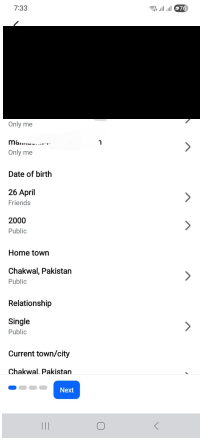


Before: *Seven active sessions were present.*

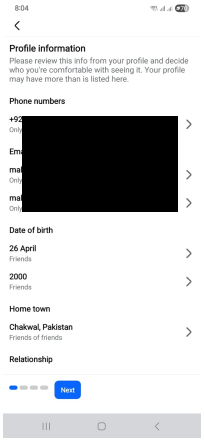


After: *Old sessions were ended; one current session remains.*

8 Facebook profile exposure

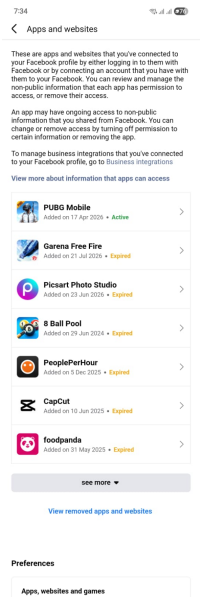


Before: *Several profile fields were publicly visible.*

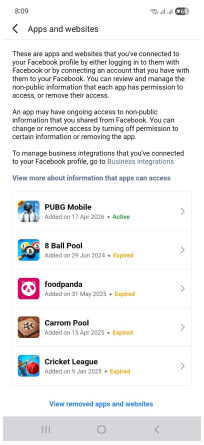


After: *Contact details were set to Only me and personal fields were restricted.*

9 Facebook connected-app cleanup



Before: *A longer list of active and expired integrations was present.*



After: *Unused integrations were removed and the list was reduced.*

Connected applications and public exposure

Connected-app audit

Account	Observed result	Action	Risk after review
Facebook	PUBG Mobile remained active; several expired records were still displayed by Facebook.	Unused integrations were removed; retained entries should be rechecked quarterly.	Low
LinkedIn	No permitted services remained after removal.	Third-party access removed.	Low
Instagram	No separate third-party integration was identified in the supplied Meta settings evidence.	Meta sharing and reuse permissions restricted.	Low
Google	No third-party connection was identified in the supplied security-settings evidence.	Security and sign-in methods reviewed.	Low

Public exposure check

A logged-out Google search for the student's name and related profile terms returned ordinary public references, including LinkedIn and social-profile results. No password, recovery code or private account content appeared in the captured results. Public professional profiles remain intentionally discoverable, while phone-based discovery and unnecessary Facebook profile details have been restricted.

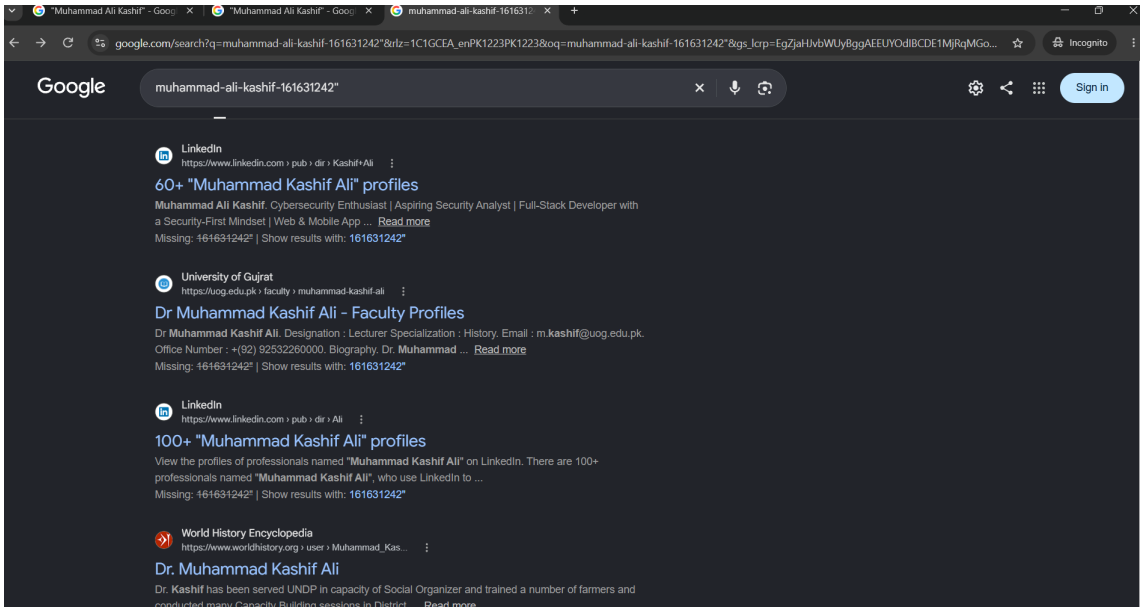


Figure 1. Logged-out public search reviewed on 20 October 2026. Search results reflect information already indexed on the public web.

Residual exposure

Search engines may retain cached profile titles or snippets for a period after privacy changes. The student should repeat the search quarterly, remove outdated public information at the original source and request search-result removal only when sensitive personal data is exposed.

Final risk assessment and recommendations

Risk area	Initial rating	Control implemented	Residual rating
Account takeover	High	2FA enabled on Google and LinkedIn; Meta 2FA confirmed.	Low
Stale sessions	High	LinkedIn sessions reduced from seven to one; Meta sessions reviewed.	Low
Unwanted discovery	Medium	Phone discoverability and profile-field visibility restricted.	Low
Network exposure	Medium	LinkedIn connections hidden; Facebook friends list restricted.	Low
Content misuse	Medium	Instagram tagging, sharing and reuse permissions reduced.	Low
Third-party access	Medium	Unused services removed and connected-app lists reviewed.	Low

Maintenance recommendations

- Review active sessions, recovery methods and connected applications every three months.
- Keep authenticator applications, passkeys and backup codes protected; never share login codes.
- Use a unique password for every account and store it in a reputable password manager.
- Check profile visibility after app updates because platforms may reorganize privacy controls.
- Repeat the public search and remove unnecessary personal details from the original profile.
- Treat unexpected login prompts as suspicious and change the affected password immediately.

Conclusion

The audit identified meaningful weaknesses across four long-standing accounts and resolved them through nine documented changes. Two-factor authentication, privacy restrictions, session cleanup and third-party access review substantially reduced the likelihood of account takeover, unwanted discovery and content misuse. The final configuration meets the project objective, with only routine monitoring and normal public-profile exposure remaining.

Declaration

I confirm that this audit was performed only on accounts that I own and that the settings described in this report reflect the evidence captured during the review.

Digitally signed by
Muhammad Ali Kashif

Date
20 October 2026

Account Hardening Checklist

A simple one-page guide for family and friends

Protect the login

[ ] Turn on two-factor authentication, preferably with an authenticator app or passkey.

[ ] Use a long, unique password for every account. Never reuse an email password.

[ ] Save recovery codes somewhere private and offline. Never send them to anyone.

[ ] Check that your recovery email and phone number are current.

Control who sees you

[ ] Set personal posts and stories to Friends, Followers or a trusted audience.

[ ] Hide your phone number, email address, birthday, hometown and relationship details.

[ ] Hide your friends or connections list when the platform allows it.

[ ] Limit who can tag, mention, repost or reuse your photos and videos.

Remove unnecessary access

[ ] Open the active-sessions page and sign out of devices you do not recognize or use.

[ ] Review connected apps and remove games, websites or services you no longer need.

[ ] Do not approve a login notification unless you personally started the sign-in.

Check public exposure

[ ] Search your name and username in a logged-out or private browser window.

[ ] Remove unnecessary personal details from the original account where they appear.

[ ] Repeat this checklist every three months and after any security alert.

If something looks wrong

Change the password, enable two-factor authentication, sign out of all other sessions, remove unknown connected apps and use the platform's official account-recovery page. Do not follow recovery links sent by strangers.